

CS106S Course Information

Welcome to Coding for Social Good!

Instructor: Ben “BTS Superfan” Yan
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Office Hours: I’ll hang around after class if you have any questions, or feel free to email / Slack me and we can find a dedicated time to chat. You’ll more than welcome to grill me on all things CS106S, CS, Stanford, and life in general; but understand that I’m a student too, still figuring stuff out, and won’t have all the answers for you or myself. But I’ll try my best!



I also tend to (infamously) be in CoDa quite a bit—especially the basement and where they serve matcha—so if you see me there, and I don’t look particularly busy / or am mid-yap session, you’re welcome to say hi, ask something or strike up a conversation.

Lectures: **Thursdays, 4:30 – 6:20 PM, Lathrop 190.** No meeting on Week 10, since there’s more pressing matters around then. We’ll have a boba party on Week 9 by tradition 🧋.

My lectures are relaxed, conversational, and best suited for a creative, workshop-style classroom environment. Each week, I’ll give a brief talk with colorful, artsy slides on some area of social good (e.g., climate change, health, trust & safety, mental health), and allow time for you to work with others on a hands-on activity, to practice your programming skills and flesh out a relevant application. We’ll come back together for a discussion, and ideally finish by 6 so you won’t miss out on any dining hall specials.

Prerequisites: The course is designed for students who are taking or who have taken CS106B/X—though this is far from a strict requirement, and **anyone is welcome to attend!** The material is honestly not that similar; I just ask that you have programmed before, and feel comfortable learning the basics of a new language, i.e. JavaScript or Python. Do reach out to me if you have any questions on whether CS106S is a good fit for you!

Grading: If you’re reading this syllabus, congratulations, you’ve already passed the class! 🎉

Just kidding, but that’s essentially the vibe: I’ve never failed any of the hundred or so students I’ve had in CS106S, and I don’t intend to lose that streak in my final year. **But formally, I’ll ask that you attend 7 of the 9 lectures, and fill out a brief check-off form at the end of each lecture you attend.** I use this to record attendance, and will know if you come to class, since I’m typically good with names and faces 😊. At the end of quarter, I’ll give everyone 1 unit of either **S/NC**, and realistically all **S** grades.

Grading is 100% attendance. There is no homework yay! I repeat: there is no work outside of lecture, except if you need to miss more than 2 lectures—which I’m happy to negotiate on a case-by-case basis, often with a chill, non-coding make-up exercise.

- Attendance:** If you need to leave early, just talk to me at the beginning of class; it's very likely ok!
- If you have to miss more than 2 classes due to difficult or extenuating circumstances (e.g., illness, personal crisis, breakup, rough week, need time to take care of yourself and your well-being, etc.), please reach out to me to receive an excused absence.
- You won't have to elaborate; I trust you.** If you miss class, please email me as well!
- Hopefully none of this happens of course, but life can be unpredictable, and stressful as it is beautiful, and **I'll always create a path for you to receive credit.** If at any point you're concerned about your standing in the course, email me, and we can meet, and find a reason to pass you—and trust me, there's many because you're all awesome ❤️.
- Resources:** All materials are advertised on the course website (cs106s.stanford.edu), which you'll want to pay a visit to when lecture begins. Lectures aren't recorded, so I'll do a good job of publishing slides, handouts, code and solutions there if you'd like to catch up. Canvas is used purely for seeing which of your friends and foes are taking 106S.
- Mailing List:** If you're enrolled in CS106S, you're automatically subscribed to the mailing list of cs106s-aut2627-students@lists.stanford.edu. I'll broadcast course announcements to your emails once a week, and any exciting life updates and gossip.
- Technology:** You'll want to bring a computer to each class, or I'll ask you to pair up with someone with one. You can program on any text editor of your choice, though I recommend VSCode or Sublime Text. Please do not use QtCreator :). You'll also need access to a web browser: Chrome will work for everything here, though Safari should also be ok!
- Policies:** All students are expected to abide by the honor code, and to treat each other with respect and dignity. We don't really have assignments in this class (or grading besides attendance moreover), so you may freely use outside resources & consult each other.
- Regarding the educator headache and lightning rod that is artificial intelligence tools, I'm actually cool with it for CS106S. I won't frown at vibe coding in part because this class is a "vibe" ☺️. I don't use AI tools myself—and personally would prefer to never use them in life (I'm too old school)—though I recognize they have some utility and certainly convenience. Ultimately, I trust that you know when it's best to use / not use AI, will do what's optimal for your learning, and I'd love to chat if you have questions!
- Fair Access:** Students who may need an academic accommodation based on the impact of a disability must initiate the request with the Office of Accessible Education (OAE). Professional staff will evaluate the request with required documentation, recommend reasonable accommodations, and prepare an Accommodation Letter for faculty dated in the current quarter in which the request is being made. Students should contact the OAE as soon as possible since timely notice is needed to coordinate accommodations. The OAE is located at 563 Salvatierra Walk (phone: **650-723-1066**).
- Thank You:** Teaching this 1-unit wonder has been a beautiful privilege and true, true joy for me. Thank you for being here to learn with us, and I hope this will be very fun for you!! 🌱
- And a shoutout to our sponsor Jerry "poohbear" Cain for making the course possible!